

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	01 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-4457
Project Name	Script-Controlled ACL – Restrict Record Access Based on Field Value
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Script-Controlled ACL Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization:

Brainstorming gave our team a free and open environment to think creatively about how to restrict record access using a Script-Controlled ACL. Volume was prioritized over value, out-of-the-box ideas were welcomed and built upon, and every member collaborated to develop a rich set of solutions for checking field values and user conditions before granting access.

We used this template to shape concepts for our project, where a custom ACL script checks the Branch field and the user's roles, and users can access a record only when the ACL script evaluates to true.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement



Script-Controlled ACL brainstorm

Our session to shape ideas for restricting record access based on field values, using a custom ACL script.

10 minutes to prepare
1 hour to collaborate
4 team members participated

>

Before you collaborate

Preparation for our Script-Controlled ACL session. Here's what we did to get going.

10 minutes

A

Team gathering

Gather the team (admins, developers, testers) and share the lab details: the u_institution_details table and roles bb1 to bb4.

B

Set the goal

Focus on how to restrict record access so users see a record only when the ACL script returns true.

C

Review ACL basics

Revisit how Read, Create, Write and Delete ACLs, roles and data conditions work in ServiceNow.

1

Define your problem statement

The problem we are solving, framed as a How Might We statement. This is the focus of our brainstorm.

5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we restrict access to records using a script-controlled ACL that checks field values and user conditions, so that users can access a record only when the ACL script evaluates to true?

Key rules of brainstorming

To run a smooth and productive session

- Stay in topic.
- Defer judgment.
- Go for volume.
- Encourage wild ideas.
- Listen to others.
- If possible, be visual.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2 Brainstorm

Write down ideas that address how to restrict record access using a Script-Controlled ACL.

10 minutes

TIP

Think about both field values (such as Branch) and user conditions (such as roles).

Team Member 1

Allow only if state is not Closed	Restrict by priority = P1	Owner can read own records
Match user department field	Check assignment group	Deny access by default

Team Member 2

Return answer = true / false	Use gs.hasRole() check	Read current.field value
Reusable Script Include	Check caller's manager	Admin bypass up front

Team Member 3

Impersonate test users	Use Security Debugger logs	Test allow and deny cases
Test in sub-prod first	Document every ACL rule	Move via update set

Team Member 4

Avoid GlideRecord in ACL	Cache role lookups	Log denied access
Dashboard of denied access	Review ACLs quarterly	Combine with data policy

3 Group ideas

We shared our ideas and clustered similar notes into themes, giving each cluster a sentence-like label.

20 minutes

TIP

Tag ideas by ACL operation (read, create, write or delete) to find and organize them easily.

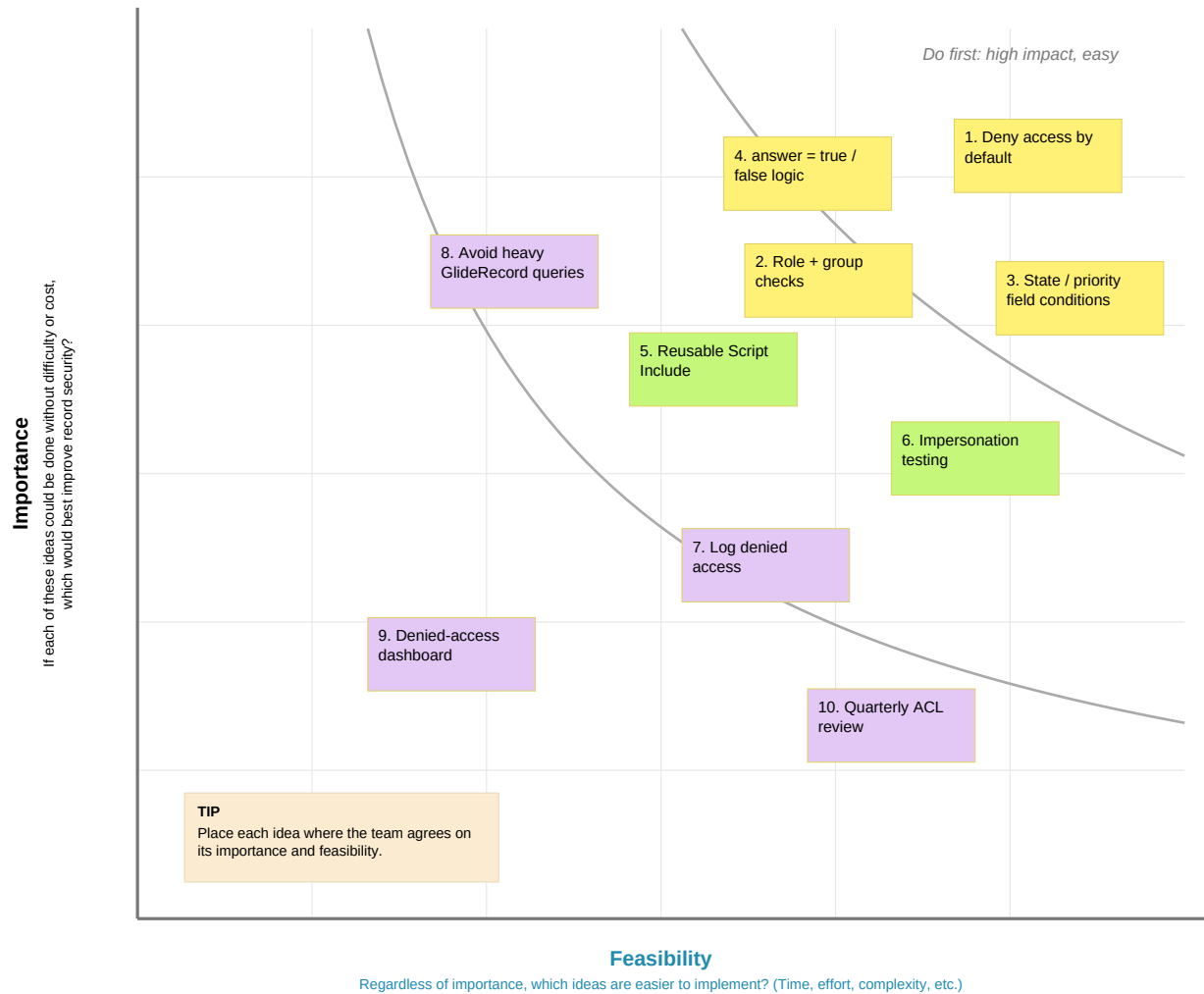
Grant access only when field values and user attributes match			Write clean script logic that returns true or false		
State / priority conditions	Role and group checks	Deny by default	answer = true / false	Script Include reuse	Use current.field values
Test every rule with real user roles before release			Keep ACLs fast, logged and reviewed over time		
Impersonate test users	Security Debugger	Positive & negative tests	Avoid heavy queries	Log denied access	Quarterly ACL review

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4 Prioritize

Our team agreed on what is important moving forward. Ideas were placed on this grid to decide which are important for record security and which are feasible in ServiceNow.

20 minutes



Priority outcome

Top-priority ideas to take forward (high importance, high feasibility): 1 Deny access by default, 2 Role + group checks, 3 State / priority field conditions, 4 answer = true / false logic.